

DATA GOVERNANCE MATURITY & ROI EXECUTIVE REPORT

Platform: **ALATION** | Scope: Enterprise Implementation | Evaluation Date: 2026-06-04

Executive Summary: An automated maturity assessment was conducted on **50** data assets managed by Alation. The implementation achieves a **Governance Health Index (GHI) of 46.01%**, reflecting moderate governance execution. Financially, the program has generated **\$19,582,763.71** in realized business value (productivity savings, incident avoidance, and compliance risk mitigation) against an estimated annual cost of **\$120,000.00**. This yields an outstanding net realized value of **\$19,462,763.71**. Additionally, the engine has identified **\$17,194,549.23** in unrealized, actionable opportunity savings that can be unlocked through targeted remediation efforts (such as decommissioning ROT storage and securing un-owned PII).

1. Governance Implementation Maturity Breakdown

Maturity is assessed across four key pillars mapped from raw vendor metadata:

Pillar Parameter	Weight	Score	Calculation Formula & Variables Mapped	Status
Documentation Completeness	30%	60.48%	Avg of: 40 (description) + 10 (length > 50) + 30 (owner) + 20 (terms)	Adequate
Data Quality Coverage	40%	49.75%	Avg of: pass_rate * 100 (0.0% if unmonitored/no DQ rules)	Action Needed
Lineage Transparency	20%	6.00%	Avg of: 50 (upstream lineage) + 50 (downstream lineage)	Action Needed
Security & Policy Risk	10%	32.30%	Avg of: 20 (sensitive) + 40 (unowned) + 20 (untagged) + 20 (0 DQ)	Moderate Risk
Governance Health Index	100%	46.01%	$GHI = (Doc*0.3) + (DQ*0.4) + (Lineage*0.2) + ((100-Risk)*0.1)$	Active

2. Program Financial Performance & ROI Analysis

The value realized through metadata-driven automation and risk mitigation compared to software licensing and overhead operating costs:

Financial Metric Category	Amount (\$)	Calculation Formula & Constant Assumptions	Value Explanation
Annual Operating Cost	\$120,000.00	Constant platform licensing & support headcount budget	Fixed software cost
Realized Discovery Savings	\$18,534,930.75	Sum of: (Annual Queries * 10% * 3.5 hrs saved * \$75/hr) * Doc Score%	Productivity savings
Realized DQ Incident Avoidance	\$810,000.00	Sum of: (4.0 baseline incidents - current incidents) * \$15k per incident	DQ debug savings
Realized Risk Avoidance	\$199,800.00	Sum of: (5% baseline breach probability - current probability) * \$150k cost	Risk mitigation

Realized Compute Optimization	\$38,032.96	Sum of: query warehouse compute credit waste avoided via data quality monitoring	Compute cost savings
Net Realized Program Value	\$19,462,763.71	Net Value = Total Realized Savings - Annual Operating Cost	Net dollar return
Return on Investment (ROI)	16218.97%	ROI % = (Net Realized Program Value / Annual Operating Cost) * 100	Efficiency score
Unrealized Opportunity Value	\$17,194,549.23	Sum of: remaining discovery opportunity + DQ opportunity + Risk + ROT storage	Unrealized pipeline

3. Executive Action Plan & Remediation Pipeline

The engine has identified key prioritized actions to reduce costs and secure sensitive corporate data:

Category A: Storage Cost Optimization (Obsolete/ROT Data Decommissioning)

Decommissioning the following zero-usage datasets yields direct cloud storage savings:

- **executive_kpi_125** : Size: **136.0 GB** (stale for 578 days). Action: Decommission or archive. Potential annual savings: **\$6.53**
- **user_retention_129** : Size: **219.2 GB** (stale for 373 days). Action: Decommission or archive. Potential annual savings: **\$2.60**
- **temp_customer_export_2024** : Size: **120.0 GB** (stale for 190 days). Action: Decommission or archive. Potential annual savings: **\$1.43**

Category B: Compliance & Exposure Mitigation (Sensitive Unowned PII/Confidential Assets)

High-exposure datasets containing sensitive tags or keywords that are missing technical owners:

- **temp_customer_export_2024** (Risk: **80.0/100**) : Read queries: **3/month**. Action: Assign Steward and apply classification tags to avoid compliance penalty risk.
- **marketing_attribution_123** (Risk: **80.0/100**) : Read queries: **8/month**. Action: Assign Steward and apply classification tags to avoid compliance penalty risk.
- **backup_restore.tar.gz_109** (Risk: **75.0/100**) : Read queries: **1833/month**. Action: Assign Steward and apply classification tags to avoid compliance penalty risk.

Category C: Business Decision Quality (High-Usage Reporting with Poor Monitoring)

Critical dashboards and datasets used extensively by the business that have failing/unmonitored data quality rules:

- **marketing_attribution_123** : Monthly queries: **8** | DQ Pass Rate: **0.0%**. Action: Build data quality verification checks in data pipeline.
- **accounts_106** : Monthly queries: **3582** | DQ Pass Rate: **0.0%**. Action: Build data quality verification checks in data pipeline.
- **marketing_attribution_126** : Monthly queries: **3564** | DQ Pass Rate: **0.0%**. Action: Build data quality verification checks in data pipeline.

APPENDIX: ROI METHODOLOGY & ASSUMPTIONS

To ensure auditability, the calculations in this executive assessment are based on the following models and parameter mappings. These baselines are grounded in industry studies conducted by Gartner, Forrester, IBM Security, and standard cloud platform metrics.

Model Baseline Constants & Citation Sources

Parameter Constants	Value	Research Context / Citation Source
Loaded Analyst Rate	\$75.00/hr	U.S. Labor Bureau senior loaded rate averages (1.35x multiplier).
Hours Saved per Search	3.5 hrs	Forrester TEI data catalog productivity metrics.
Annual Storage Cost / GB	\$0.24	Standard hot cloud object tier blended averages (AWS, Azure).
Data Quality Error Cost	\$15,000.00	Gartner & Monte Carlo operational cost studies.
Compliance Breach Penalty	\$150,000.00	IBM Cost of Data Breach localized/tier-1 infraction fine.

Equations & Derivations

- Productivity Savings:** $(\text{Annual Queries} * 10\% \text{ search ratio}) * 3.5 \text{ hrs saved} * \text{Analyst loaded rate} * (\text{Doc Score} / 100)$. Grounded in Forrester's TEI frameworks.
- ROT Decommissioning:** Identified as size > 0, queries < 5/mo, and last accessed > 180 days. Savings = GB Size * \$0.24/yr. Grounded in AWS/Azure storage tiers.
- DQ Incident Avoidance:** $(\text{Unmonitored baseline [4.0]} - \text{Current incidents}) * \15k cost . Active DQ profiling drops current errors to 2.0 (for DQ >= 80%) or 0.0 (for DQ >= 95%). Grounded in Gartner data quality impact surveys.
- Risk Avoidance:** $(\text{Baseline breach prob. [5.0\%]} - \text{Current prob.}) * \$150\text{k breach penalty}$. Controls (ownership and classification) reduce probability to 1.0% (0.2% with active DQ checks). Grounded in IBM Security breach statistics and DAMA DMBOK principles.